

Congratulations! You've Won a Shopping Spree

Contrary to Jack, Jessica knew that she was in trouble. She was opening her mail and taking the collectors' phone calls, but there just wasn't anything she could do. Jessica wondered how she had gotten herself into the mess she was in. She thought back to that day at the car dealership.

She knew she needed another car. Her old car had finally died after her parents had handed it down to her sister, then her brother, and finally to Jessica. Her parents were very conservative, having been raised in rural Kansas, and never bought anything new. They felt it was a waste of money. Jessica was used to getting things that had been preowned.

Jessica had no intention of buying a new car, she fully intended on getting a used one. But once she was at the dealership, the salesman showed her how she could afford a new automobile with 100 percent financing. This meant that she didn't have to put any money down and she could leave with a new car. Jessica thought this was a great deal and the added perk of finally having something that was brand new was too much to resist. She promptly signed all the paperwork and left with her new Toyota Camry.

Jessica made her first mistake. She made a major purchase on impulse and on the first day of shopping! Always let the salesman know that you will be shopping several dealerships. Don't fall for the line, "Special price for today only." If you make an impulse purchase you may regret it for several reasons:

1. Your payment may be higher than you had planned to spend.
2. Your insurance payment is outrageous.
3. You could have gotten a better deal at a dealer across town.

